Stage-by-Stage Impact of Blind Hiring

0 Summary

Core Thesis:

The traditional justification for blind hiring is built on the assumption of *in-group favoritism* — the premise that majority gatekeepers harbor implicit biases against underrepresented minorities (URMs) and systematically favor candidates who look like themselves. Blind hiring is theoretically deployed to level the playing field by removing demographic noise'' and revealing pure technicalsignal.’’

Our experiment demonstrates the *exact opposite* is occurring in modern software engineering hiring.

Because majority gatekeepers organically apply an informal out-group premium'' to minority candidates, blinding demographic information fundamentally reshuffles hiring outcomes --- mechanically harming URMs and boosting White Males. Furthermore, this informal bias is highly elastic to formal corporate policy. When firms lack explicit diversity mandates, individual evaluators engage in \emph{compensatory bias}, informally boosting minority scores. Enforcing blind hiring in these environments destroys this potential safety net. Finally, despite claims that demographics are distractingnoise,’’ blinding resumes yielded *no improvement* in the actual technical quality of the selected candidates.

1 Treatment Effect on Evaluations (Reshuffling)

- **Finding:** Blinding demographic information during candidate evaluation *reshuffles* hiring outcomes by disrupting a pre-existing system of *demographic premiums and penalties*. Blind hiring removes a *baseline penalty* that White Males were experiencing in the non-blind evaluations, while simultaneously stripping Hispanic candidates of an *(diversity) premium*.
  - **Winners: White Males.** Evaluated by Engineers, White Male overall scores mechanically rise by +8.5% of a SD under blinding.
  - **Losers: Hispanic candidates.** When stripped of their demographic identity, Hispanic Male scores plunge by -11.5% of a SD (evaluated by HR), and Hispanic Female scores fall by -6.9% of a SD (evaluated by Engineers).
- **Caveat:** Hiring is often an *ordinal ranking* problem — one candidate's gain corresponds to another's lost opportunity — so the absence of statistical significance on a given row does not mean the corresponding group is unaffected by blinding.

Treatment Effects of Blinding for	Panel A: HR	Panel B: Engineer
	HR	Engineer
White Male	0.037	0.085***
	(0.057)	(0.028)
White Female	0.013	0.023
	(0.051)	(0.036)
Asian Male	0.015	−0.018
	(0.059)	(0.028)
Asian Female	−0.023	−0.029
	(0.048)	(0.029)
Hispanic Male	−0.115**	−0.003
	(0.048)	(0.030)
Hispanic Female	0.087*	−0.069**
	(0.052)	(0.034)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2772
R^2	0.423	0.743
Adj. R^2	0.408	0.737

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

1.1 Heterogeneity: Rejecting Traditional In-Group Favoritism

- **Finding:** Our experiment shows that the modern tech industry actually operates on a preference for the *out-group* (or preference for *under-represented groups*). Because White Males make up the majority of the evaluator pool, their behavior drives the aggregate metrics. When you blind resumes, the scores of concordant (race/gender) applicants evaluated by Engineers actually rise by +6.9% of a SD ($p < 0.05$) while the scores of discordant applicants fall by -0.9% of a SD ($p < 0.05$).
- **Takeaway:** This shows that, under non-blinded evaluations, the majority gatekeepers were *actively penalizing* candidates who looked like themselves and assigning a *premium to evaluation scores of minority candidates*. Enforcing blind hiring doesn't stop discrimination against minorities; it stops the White Male majority from systematically boosting them. This explains why, in our experiment, White Male applicants are the primary beneficiaries of blind hiring: they are "rescued" from the baseline penalty imposed by their own demographic engineer peers.

	Concordant Race		Concordant Gender		Concordant Race AND Gender	
	HR	Eng	HR	Eng	HR	Eng
Concordant Applicant	−0.020	0.045*	−0.010	0.029*	−0.076	0.069**
	(0.042)	(0.023)	(0.027)	(0.015)	(0.068)	(0.032)
Nonconcordant Applicant	0.007	−0.014*	0.009	−0.030*	0.011	−0.009**
	(0.015)	(0.007)	(0.025)	(0.016)	(0.010)	(0.004)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2772	2466	2772	2466	2772
R^2	0.421	0.742	0.421	0.742	0.421	0.742
Adj. R^2	0.407	0.737	0.407	0.737	0.408	0.737

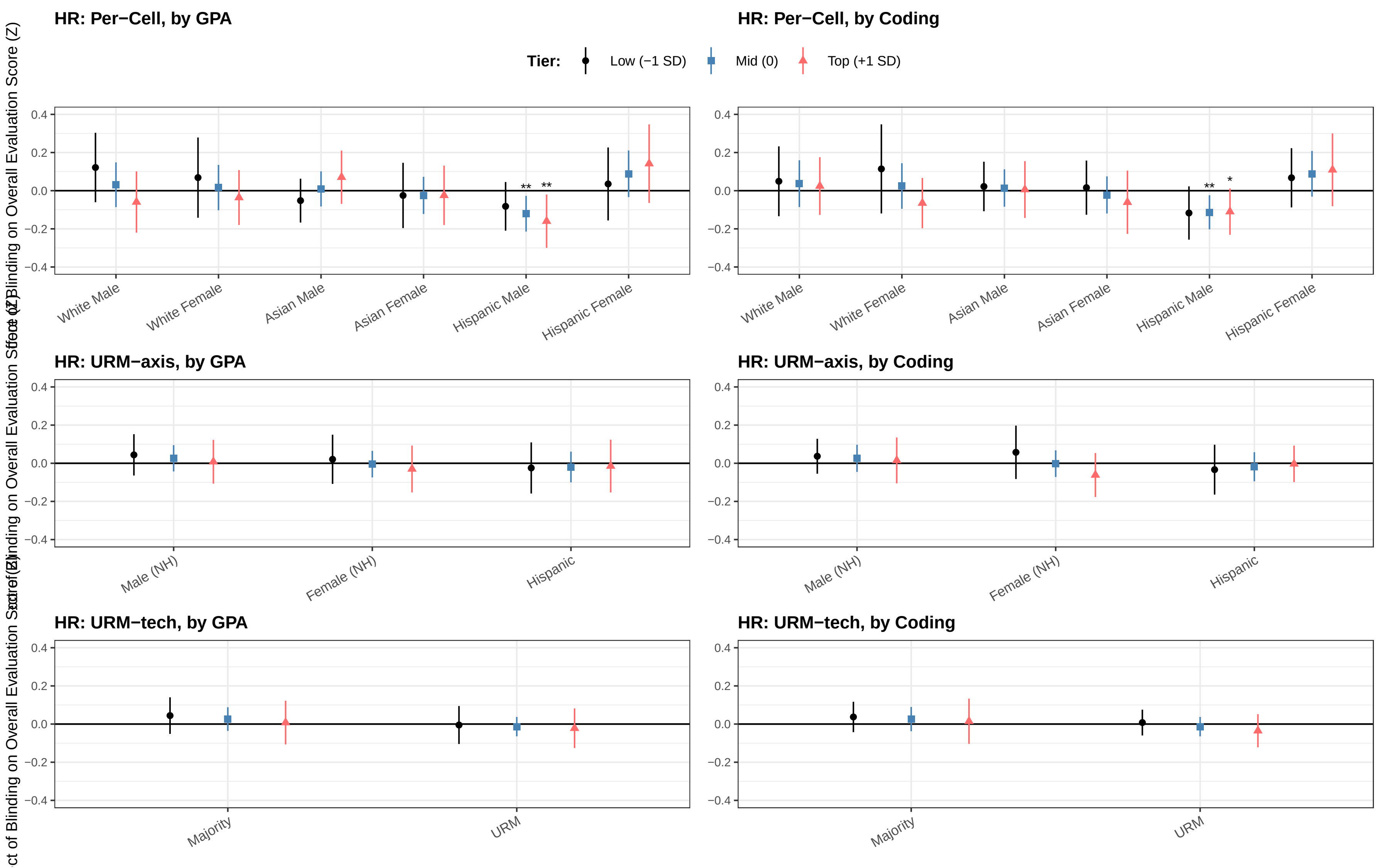
* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

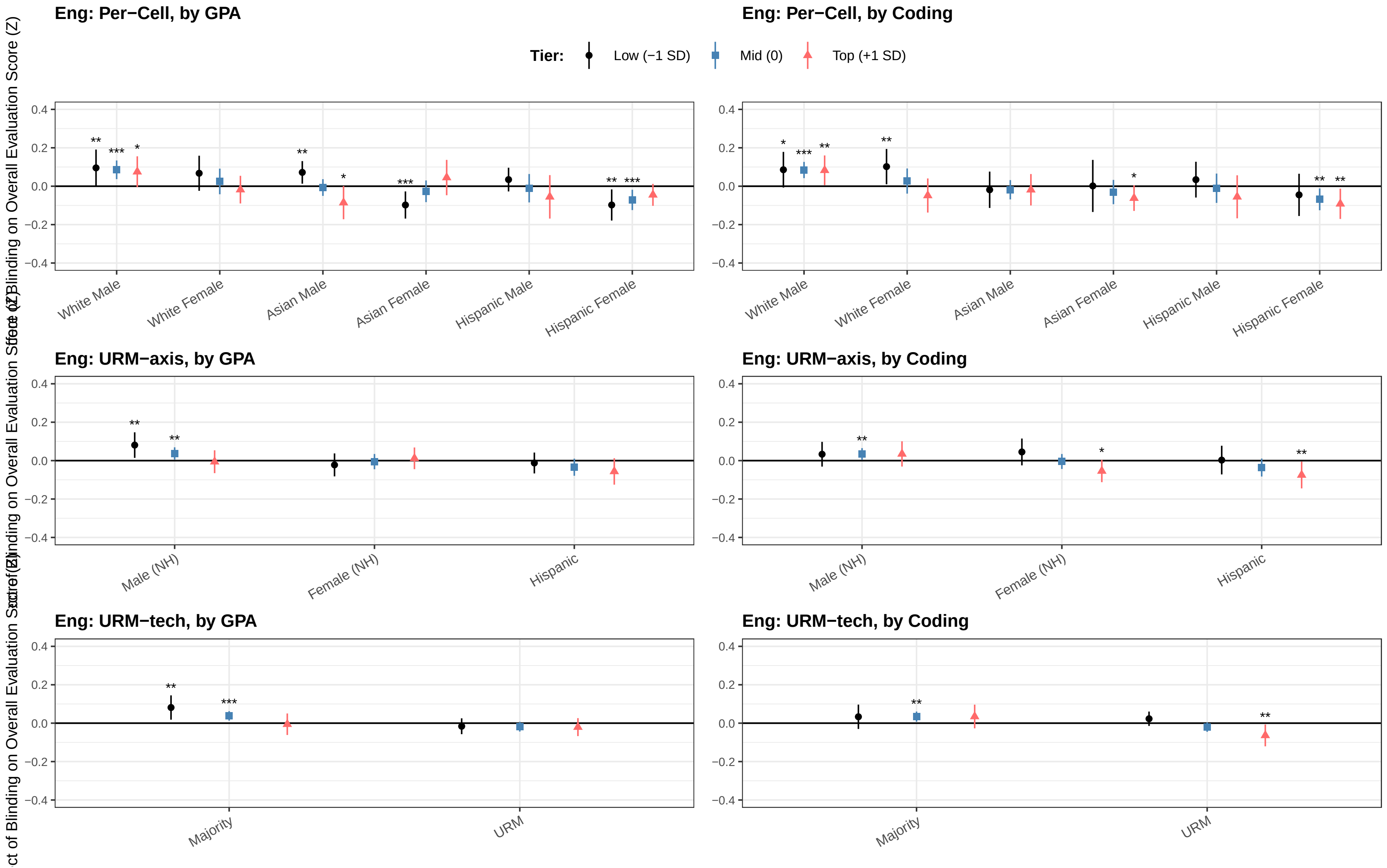
1.2 Heterogeneity: Where the Demographic Premium Applies (Effects by Candidate Quality)

Spec. Single pooled regression per (demographic, quality) pair: `-sc_overall_z` ∼ `factor*quality_z + linear age` | `resume_index + r_do + resp FEs`, with `quality_z` $\in$ {`gpa_z`, `test_case_z`} as the standardized continuous quality variable and `factor` $\in$ {`race_gender` (6 cells), `urm_axis_blind` (Male NH / Female NH / Hispanic), `urm_tech_blind` (Majority / URM)}. Two-way cluster on `responseid + resume_index`. Plotted TE points are at -1, 0, $+1$ SD of the standardized quality score (labelled "Low / Mid / Top") via the linear combination $\hat{\beta}_D + q \cdot \hat{\beta}_{D\times\text{quality}}$, $q \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$.

HR Evaluators (Continuous quality, drop nonlinear age, r_do)



Engineer Evaluators (Continuous quality, drop nonlinear age, r_do)



2 Individual Response to Institutional Policy (Institutional Crowding Out or Compensatory Bias)

Takeaway / Summary.

- **The Puzzle of Individual Ideology:** The two-way relationship between an evaluator's personal DEI priority and their evaluation scores is surprisingly *muted and statistically noisy*. At first glance, personal ideology appears to have little impact on how blind hiring reshuffles outcomes.
  - **Compensatory Bias** (Firms with NO Diversity Mandate, see red lines): When a firm lacks an explicit objective policy targeting URMs, highly pro-DEI HR professionals engage in *compensatory bias* — filling the perceived institutional void by informally inflating minority candidates' scores in the baseline.
  - **Institutional Crowding-Out** (Firms WITH a Diversity Mandate, see blue lines): Conversely, when the firm explicitly mandates URM targeting, this formal policy *crowds out* the evaluator's informal efforts; pro-DEI HR professionals *mute* their premium to under-represented minorities' scores.
- (Note the *divergence between HR and Engineer results*, particularly in the triple-interaction columns.)

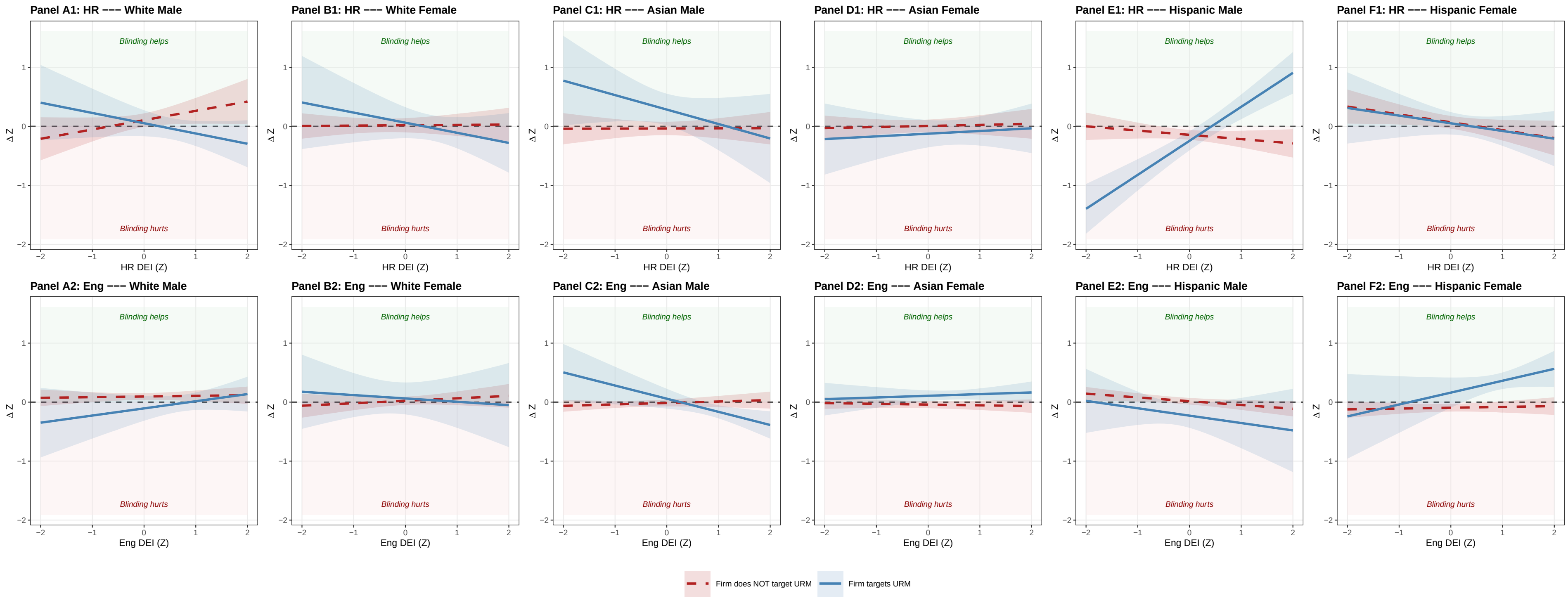
Note on Key Index Creation.

- *Individual DEI Index (Z)*: Evaluator's personal DEI orientation, condensed into a single z-scored score. (Low = Anti-DEI, High = Pro-DEI)
  - Mathematical expression: Index $= z\big(\frac{1}{5}\sum_{j=1}^{5} z(x_j)\big)$, z-scored within (`role`, `treat`) cells.
  - `pro_dei_race` — stated agreement that race DEI is important in hiring (Likert).
  - `pro_dei_gender` — stated agreement that gender DEI is important in hiring (Likert).
  - `pro_diverse` — stated importance of working at a company with a diverse workforce (Likert).
  - `pro_hiring_dei` — stated belief that DEI initiatives help firms hire better candidates (Likert).
  - `div_priority` — revealed-priority rank of "Diversity and Representation" in the seven-goals question.
- *Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)*: Indicator for firm policy — whether the evaluator's firm formally targets Female or Hispanic candidates in hiring.
  - Mathematical expression: Idx $= \mathbb{1}\{\texttt{firm\_targets\_female} = 1 \lor \texttt{firm\_targets\_hispanic} = 1\}$.
  - `firm_targets_female` — 1 if option 6 ("Female") was selected on `s5_policy_diversity` (multi-select).
  - `firm_targets_hispanic` — 1 if option 3 ("Hispanic or Latino") was selected on the same multi-select.
- *Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)*: Respondent's perception of how much attention their firm currently pays to race and gender DEI in hiring, condensed into a single z-scored score.
  - Mathematical expression: Index $= z\big(\frac{1}{2}\big(z(\texttt{race\_attn}) + z(\texttt{gender\_attn})\big)\big)$, z-scored within (`role`, `treat`) cells.
  - `s5_view_dei_race_f` — Likert: respondent's perception of firm's current attention to race DEI in hiring.
  - `s5_view_dei_gender_f` — Likert: respondent's perception of firm's current attention to gender DEI in hiring.

2.1 By Six Demographics

	Simple DEI Heterogeneity		Triple: Firm Targets URM		Triple: Firm Pays DEI Attention	
	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer
White Male	0.060 (0.053)	0.085*** (0.028)	0.105* (0.059)	0.095*** (0.029)	0.129** (0.062)	0.054* (0.030)
White Female	0.011 (0.052)	0.022 (0.035)	0.019 (0.062)	0.023 (0.036)	0.000 (0.067)	0.032 (0.036)
Asian Male	0.015 (0.060)	−0.018 (0.028)	−0.036 (0.058)	−0.014 (0.030)	0.073 (0.068)	−0.028 (0.034)
Asian Female	−0.021 (0.048)	−0.030 (0.029)	0.007 (0.055)	−0.041 (0.031)	−0.027 (0.060)	−0.020 (0.042)
Hispanic Male	−0.109** (0.046)	−0.003 (0.029)	−0.144*** (0.043)	0.016 (0.029)	−0.178*** (0.053)	0.030 (0.028)
Hispanic Female	0.064 (0.047)	−0.070** (0.033)	0.069 (0.055)	−0.095*** (0.033)	0.033 (0.055)	−0.081* (0.047)
White Male × Individual DEI Index (Z)	0.098 (0.079)	0.010 (0.032)	0.158* (0.091)	0.011 (0.034)	0.165** (0.066)	0.040 (0.045)
White Female × Individual DEI Index (Z)	−0.017 (0.051)	0.037 (0.047)	0.006 (0.056)	0.042 (0.048)	−0.001 (0.069)	−0.011 (0.046)
Asian Male × Individual DEI Index (Z)	−0.005 (0.064)	0.014 (0.026)	0.002 (0.062)	0.024 (0.028)	−0.022 (0.066)	0.044 (0.048)
Asian Female × Individual DEI Index (Z)	0.009 (0.046)	−0.006 (0.022)	0.018 (0.053)	−0.013 (0.022)	−0.006 (0.060)	0.008 (0.050)
Hispanic Male × Individual DEI Index (Z)	0.020 (0.062)	−0.076*** (0.028)	−0.073 (0.056)	−0.064** (0.028)	−0.034 (0.069)	−0.096** (0.041)
Hispanic Female × Individual DEI Index (Z)	−0.135** (0.062)	0.037 (0.034)	−0.133* (0.069)	0.014 (0.033)	−0.153*** (0.056)	0.012 (0.065)
White Male × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.052 (0.128)	−0.201* (0.110)		
White Female × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.043 (0.149)	0.040 (0.142)		
Asian Male × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.320** (0.148)	0.073 (0.090)		
Asian Female × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.131 (0.132)	0.149*** (0.055)		
Hispanic Male × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.102 (0.093)	−0.245** (0.109)		
Hispanic Female × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.017 (0.112)	0.256* (0.135)		
White Male × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.034 (0.108)	0.011 (0.027)
White Female × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.110 (0.068)	0.032 (0.043)
Asian Male × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.130* (0.074)	−0.046 (0.041)
Asian Female × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.015 (0.077)	−0.042 (0.037)
Hispanic Male × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.168** (0.069)	0.021 (0.026)
Hispanic Female × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.115 (0.080)	0.033 (0.052)
White Male × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.332** (0.153)	0.110 (0.111)		
White Female × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.177 (0.164)	−0.098 (0.163)		
Asian Male × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.247 (0.192)	−0.247*** (0.090)		
Asian Female × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.028 (0.130)	0.041 (0.059)		
Hispanic Male × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.649*** (0.106)	−0.061 (0.154)		
Hispanic Female × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.003 (0.147)	0.188 (0.128)		
White Male × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.222* (0.125)	0.024 (0.030)
White Female × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.014 (0.090)	0.006 (0.041)
Asian Male × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.219** (0.088)	0.003 (0.027)
Asian Female × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.036 (0.078)	−0.022 (0.029)
Hispanic Male × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.159* (0.085)	−0.046** (0.022)
Hispanic Female × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.218** (0.104)	0.041 (0.046)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2772	2466	2772	2160	2358

Standard errors clustered by respondent.



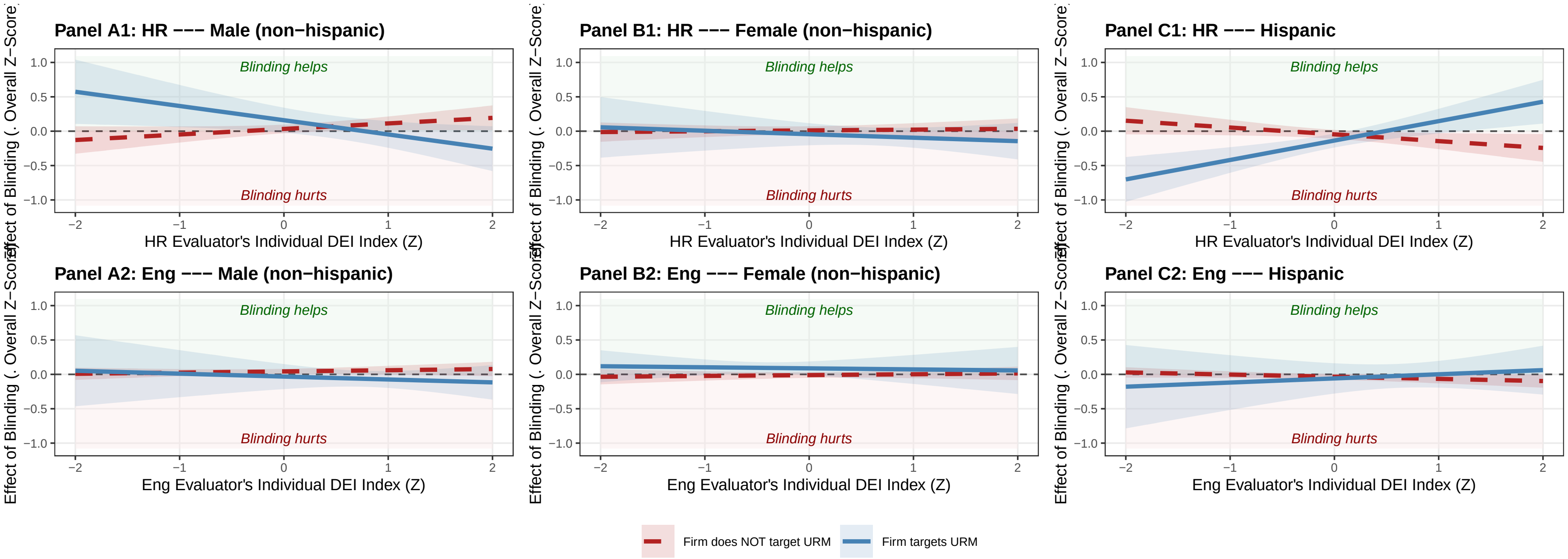
Marginal-effects "scissors" plot built from the §2.1 columns 3-4 (HR & Engineer triple with Firm Targets Fem/His), per race-gender. Top row: HR evaluators (Panels A1–F1). Bottom row: Engineer evaluators (Panels A2–F2). Lines: predicted effect of blinding on each group's overall score as a function of the rater's Individual DEI Index (Z); shaded bands are 95% CIs (SE clustered by respondent).

2.2 By Trichotomy (Majority vs Gender Minority vs Racial Minority)

	Simple DEI Heterogeneity		Triple: Firm Targets URM		Triple: Firm Pays DEI Attention	
	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer
Male (non-hispanic)	0.036	0.036*	0.032	0.043**	0.099**	0.015
	(0.034)	(0.019)	(0.032)	(0.019)	(0.038)	(0.019)
Female (non-hispanic)	−0.007	−0.005	0.011	−0.011	−0.016	0.005
	(0.028)	(0.020)	(0.031)	(0.021)	(0.034)	(0.025)
Hispanic	−0.030	−0.033	−0.046	−0.034	−0.084***	−0.021
	(0.032)	(0.021)	(0.033)	(0.021)	(0.032)	(0.026)
Male (NH) × Individual DEI Index (Z)	0.048	0.012	0.080*	0.017	0.074**	0.042
	(0.043)	(0.022)	(0.046)	(0.023)	(0.036)	(0.032)
Female (NH) × Individual DEI Index (Z)	−0.002	0.014	0.012	0.012	−0.001	0.000
	(0.031)	(0.024)	(0.034)	(0.025)	(0.037)	(0.032)
Hispanic × Individual DEI Index (Z)	−0.048	−0.027	−0.099**	−0.031	−0.079*	−0.045
	(0.046)	(0.019)	(0.048)	(0.019)	(0.043)	(0.038)
Male (NH) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.127	−0.075		
			(0.099)	(0.095)		
Female (NH) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.055	0.098*		
			(0.089)	(0.055)		
Hispanic × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.091	−0.025		
			(0.061)	(0.114)		
Male (NH) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.046	−0.017
					(0.055)	(0.023)
Female (NH) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.064	−0.006
					(0.039)	(0.025)
Hispanic × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.020	0.025
					(0.052)	(0.026)
Male (NH) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.287***	−0.060		
			(0.102)	(0.094)		
Female (NH) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.062	−0.028		
			(0.089)	(0.074)		
Hispanic × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.381***	0.092		
			(0.093)	(0.115)		
Male (NH) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.221***	0.013
					(0.069)	(0.022)
Female (NH) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.027	−0.009
					(0.055)	(0.022)
Hispanic × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.195***	−0.005
					(0.072)	(0.023)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2772	2466	2772	2160	2358

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Standard errors clustered by respondent.



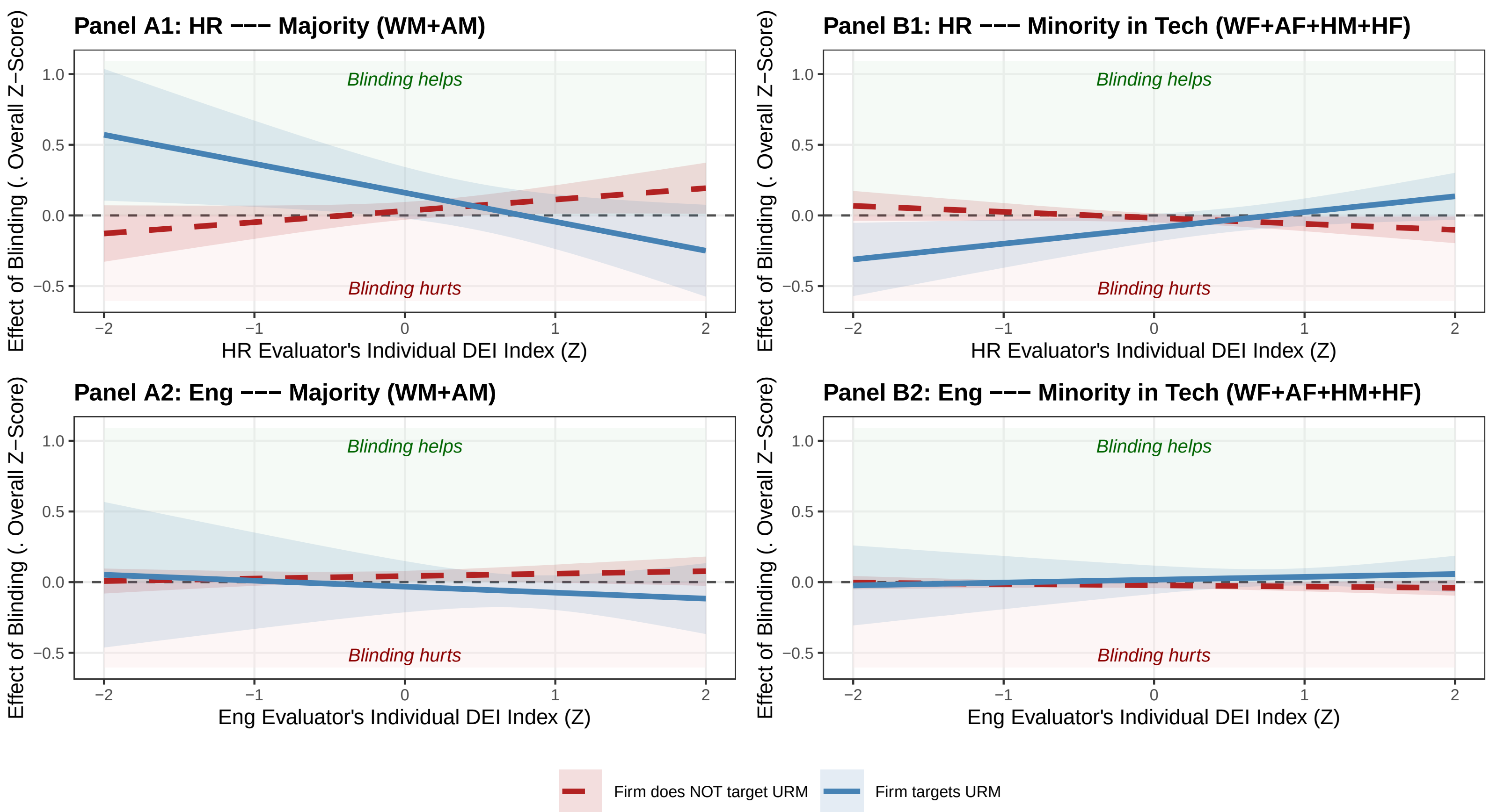
Marginal-effects "scissors" plot built from the §2.2 columns 3-4 (HR & Engineer triple with Firm Targets Fem/His). Top row: HR evaluators (Panels A1, B1, C1). Bottom row: Engineer evaluators (Panels A2, B2, C2). Lines: predicted effect of blinding on each group's overall score as a function of the rater's Individual DEI Index (Z); shaded bands are 95% CIs from the linear combination of axis-triple coefficients (SE clustered by respondent).

2.3 By Dichotomy (Majority vs Minority)

	Simple DEI Heterogeneity		Triple: Firm Targets URM		Triple: Firm Pays DEI Attention	
	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer
Majority (WM+AM)	0.036	0.035*	0.032	0.043**	0.099**	0.014
	(0.034)	(0.019)	(0.032)	(0.019)	(0.038)	(0.019)
Minority in Tech (WF+AF+HM+HF)	−0.018	−0.018*	−0.017	−0.022**	−0.050**	−0.008
	(0.018)	(0.010)	(0.017)	(0.010)	(0.020)	(0.010)
Majority (WM+AM) × Individual DEI Index (Z)	0.048	0.012	0.080*	0.017	0.074**	0.042
	(0.043)	(0.022)	(0.046)	(0.023)	(0.036)	(0.032)
Minority in Tech (WF+AF+HM+HF) × Individual DEI Index (Z)	−0.025	−0.006	−0.042*	−0.009	−0.039**	−0.022
	(0.023)	(0.012)	(0.024)	(0.012)	(0.019)	(0.017)
Majority (WM+AM) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.128	−0.075		
			(0.099)	(0.094)		
Minority in Tech (WF+AF+HM+HF) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.071	0.039		
			(0.053)	(0.052)		
Majority (WM+AM) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.046	−0.017
					(0.054)	(0.023)
Minority in Tech (WF+AF+HM+HF) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.022	0.009
					(0.027)	(0.012)
Majority (WM+AM) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			−0.285***	−0.060		
			(0.101)	(0.094)		
Minority in Tech (WF+AF+HM+HF) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm Targets Fem/His (0/1)			0.154***	0.029		
			(0.055)	(0.051)		
Majority (WM+AM) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					−0.221***	0.013
					(0.069)	(0.022)
Minority in Tech (WF+AF+HM+HF) × Individual DEI Index (Z) × Firm DEI Attn Index (Z)					0.111***	−0.007
					(0.035)	(0.012)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2466	2772	2466	2772	2160	2358

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Standard errors clustered by respondent.



Marginal-effects “scissors” plot built from the §2.3 columns 3-4 (HR & Engineer triple with Firm Targets Fem/His) under the URM-Tech dichotomy. Top row: HR evaluators (Panels A1, B1). Bottom row: Engineer evaluators (Panels A2, B2). Lines: predicted effect of blinding on each group’s overall score as a function of the rater’s Individual DEI Index (Z); shaded bands are 95% CIs (SE clustered by respondent).

3 Inter-Departmental Backlash and Compensation: Signed Directional Index

Spec. Triple-interaction model with a **signed, DEI-specific, directional** perception index per role: positive end captures the role-appropriate "misalignment in the bad direction' ' (HR overreach for Eng; Eng undercare for HR); negative end captures the opposite direction. Both directions are continuous, not thresholded.

Survey directional structure (used directly). The multi-select options `aligndiff{role}_1..6` record which DEI dimensions the respondent flagged, and the items themselves are directional:

- Options 1 / 4: counterpart places *higher* priority on gender / racial diversity (rebellion-relevant for Eng; over-care-relevant for HR).
- Options 2 / 5: counterpart places *lower* priority on gender / racial diversity (under-care-relevant for HR; opposite-direction signal for Eng).
- Options 3 / 6: counterpart places priority on *different* groups (no direction — ignored here).

Index construction (per role; respondent-level then merged back):

- **Eng (HR Overreach direction).** Likert: `s5_hr_influence` (1–4, "to what extent does HR push DEI in hiring"; higher = more push). Directional count: $(\texttt{aligndiffeng}_1 + \texttt{aligndiffeng}_4) - (\texttt{aligndiffeng}_2 + \texttt{aligndiffeng}_5)$ (positive = HR cares more on race/gender DEI; negative = HR cares less). Composite: `eng_dir = s5_hr_influence + 0.5 · directional_count`, then z-scored within Eng.
- **HR (Eng Undercare direction).** Likert: `-s5_engineer_care` (negated 0–4 "to what extent does Eng prioritize DEI"; higher negated = Eng cares less). Directional count: $(\texttt{aligndiffhr}_2 + \texttt{aligndiffhr}_5) - (\texttt{aligndiffhr}_1 + \texttt{aligndiffhr}_4)$ (positive = Eng cares less on race/gender DEI; negative = Eng cares more). Composite: `hr_dir = -s5_engineer_care + 0.5 · directional_count`, then z-scored within HR.
- `misalign_z` = `eng_dir_z` for Eng rows / `hr_dir_z` for HR rows, used as `perc_role` in the regressions. Sample inclusion: drop only respondents NA on the Likert anchor (`s5_hr_influence` for Eng / `s5_engineer_care` for HR).

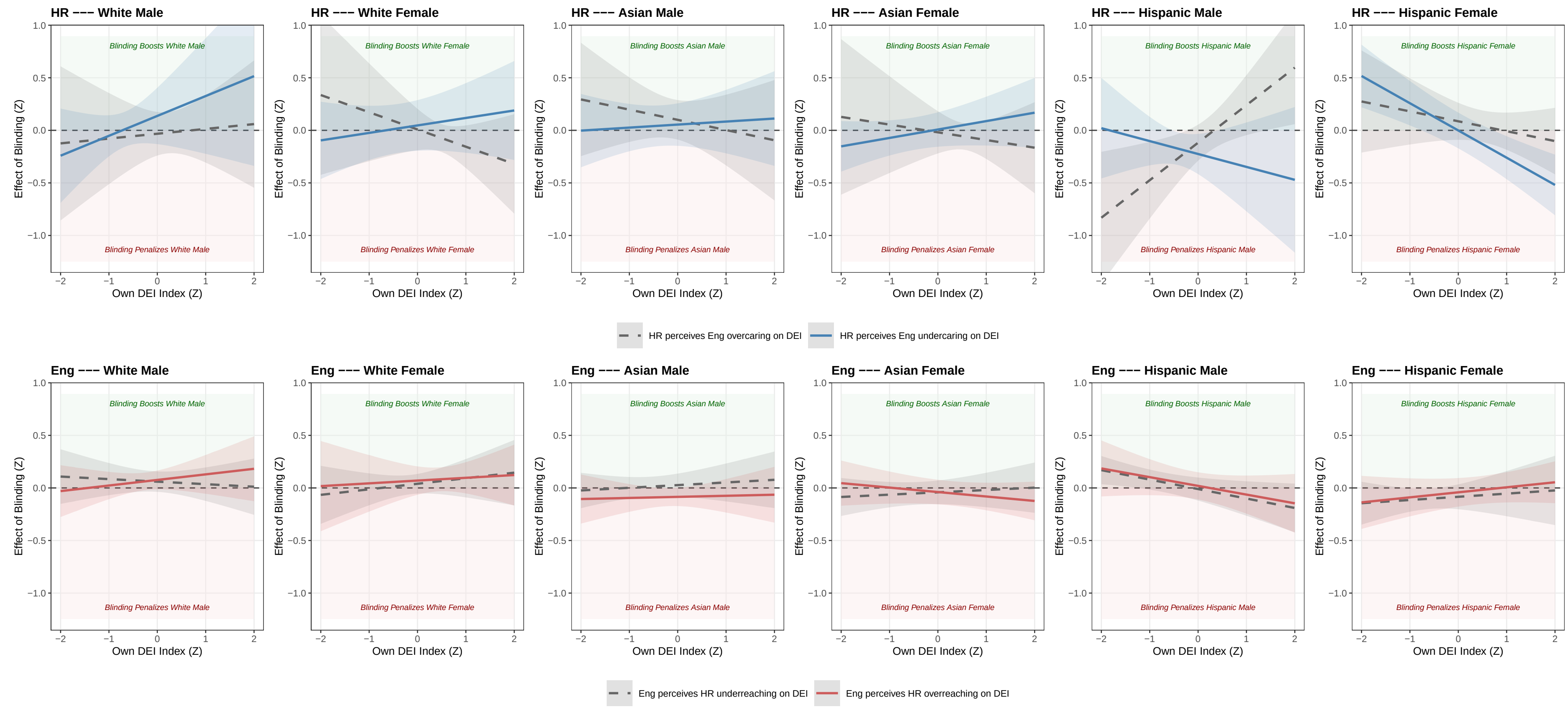
Substantive interpretation. `perc_role` > 0 = `rebellion conditions'' for Eng /`compensation conditions' ' for HR; `perc_role` < 0 = the opposite direction (Eng who think HR underreaches; HR who think Eng overcares). Triple-interaction slopes can therefore be read as: *how does the effect of blinding on group X change as the rater moves from "counterpart cares too little on DEI" to "counterpart cares too much on DEI"?*

3.1 By Six Demographics

	Simple Dir Het.		Triple: Dir x Own DEI	
	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer
White Male	0.016 (0.071)	0.086*** (0.027)	0.052 (0.095)	0.068** (0.031)
White Female	−0.020 (0.066)	0.050 (0.038)	0.027 (0.076)	0.055 (0.045)
Asian Male	0.051 (0.051)	−0.032 (0.035)	0.077 (0.053)	−0.029 (0.041)
Asian Female	−0.036 (0.051)	−0.055 (0.034)	−0.006 (0.066)	−0.040 (0.036)
Hispanic Male	−0.083 (0.060)	0.005 (0.050)	−0.171** (0.079)	0.005 (0.051)
Hispanic Female	0.081 (0.067)	−0.058 (0.042)	0.042 (0.069)	−0.063 (0.053)
White Male × Dir Idx (Z)	0.008 (0.055)	0.022 (0.049)	0.085 (0.077)	0.008 (0.036)
White Female × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.008 (0.064)	0.030 (0.033)	0.019 (0.082)	0.015 (0.038)
Asian Male × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.032 (0.081)	−0.050 (0.032)	−0.023 (0.084)	−0.056* (0.030)
Asian Female × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.019 (0.053)	−0.010 (0.034)	0.013 (0.066)	0.001 (0.046)
Hispanic Male × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.002 (0.051)	−0.023 (0.034)	−0.054 (0.049)	0.015 (0.034)
Hispanic Female × Dir Idx (Z)	0.060 (0.056)	0.038 (0.040)	−0.044 (0.055)	0.021 (0.038)
White Male × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.118 (0.121)	0.014 (0.060)
White Female × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.046 (0.109)	0.040 (0.058)
Asian Male × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.034 (0.082)	0.018 (0.046)
Asian Female × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.003 (0.083)	−0.010 (0.034)
Hispanic Male × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.117 (0.104)	−0.086** (0.040)
Hispanic Female × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.177*** (0.059)	0.039 (0.042)
White Male × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.072 (0.107)	0.039 (0.024)
White Female × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.117* (0.061)	−0.013 (0.055)
Asian Male × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.063 (0.078)	−0.007 (0.030)
Asian Female × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.077 (0.074)	−0.032 (0.028)
Hispanic Male × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.240** (0.098)	0.004 (0.033)
Hispanic Female × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.082 (0.054)	0.009 (0.036)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2034	2124	2034	2124
R^2	0.433	0.739	0.441	0.740
Adj. R^2	0.414	0.731	0.418	0.730
R^2 Within	0.003	0.007	0.016	0.011
Adj. R^2 Within	−0.004	0.000	0.002	−0.002

Dir Idx (Z) = signed directional misalignment index: for Eng, HR Overreach direction (Likert + 0.5 times signed multi-select); for HR, Eng Undercare direction. Z-scored within role. Positive = rebellion conditions for Eng / compensation conditions for HR; negative = opposite. n = 113 HR, 118 Eng. Coefs flipped post-fit so positive = effect of blinding raises the score. Two-way cluster on responseid and resume index.

Dir Idx (signed) × Own DEI Index — Per Race-Gender (6 cells)



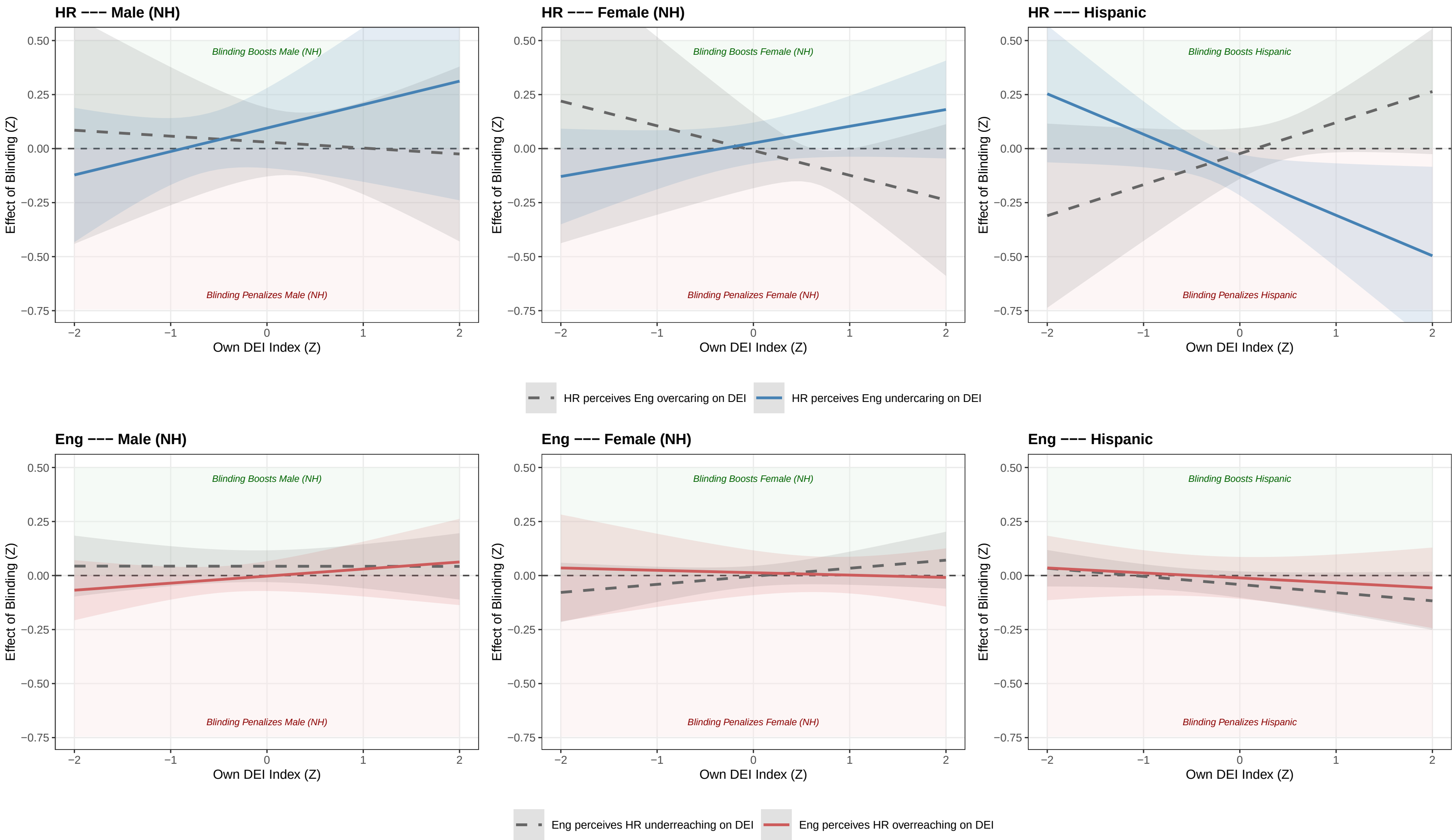
Top row: HR (high Dir = perceives Eng undercare = compensation conditions). Bottom row: Eng (high Dir = perceives HR overreach = rebellion conditions). Bands = 95% CI.

3.2 By Trichotomy (Majority vs Gender Minority vs Racial Minority)

	Simple Dir Het.		Triple: Dir x Own DEI	
	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer
Male (NH)	0.033 (0.043)	0.028 (0.020)	0.063 (0.059)	0.020 (0.025)
Female (NH)	−0.029 (0.041)	−0.006 (0.024)	0.008 (0.055)	0.005 (0.033)
Hispanic	−0.005 (0.044)	−0.024 (0.031)	−0.072 (0.049)	−0.026 (0.033)
Male (NH) × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.011 (0.055)	−0.013 (0.033)	0.033 (0.065)	−0.023 (0.027)
Female (NH) × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.013 (0.036)	0.010 (0.017)	0.017 (0.046)	0.008 (0.025)
Hispanic × Dir Idx (Z)	0.025 (0.029)	0.004 (0.030)	−0.049** (0.023)	0.015 (0.025)
Male (NH) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.041 (0.084)	0.016 (0.035)
Female (NH) × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.019 (0.079)	0.013 (0.027)
Hispanic × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.022 (0.072)	−0.030 (0.025)
Male (NH) × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.068 (0.068)	0.016 (0.012)
Female (NH) × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.096 (0.056)	−0.024 (0.026)
Hispanic × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.166*** (0.053)	0.007 (0.018)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2034	2124	2034	2124
R^2	0.432	0.737	0.436	0.738
Adj. R^2	0.415	0.730	0.417	0.729
R^2 Within	0.001	0.001	0.009	0.002
Adj. R^2 Within	−0.003	−0.003	0.000	−0.005

Dir Idx (Z) = signed directional misalignment index. n = 113 HR, 118 Eng. Coefs flipped post-fit so positive = effect of blinding raises the score. Two-way cluster on responseid and resume index.

Dir Idx (signed) × Own DEI Index — URM-Axis Trichotomy



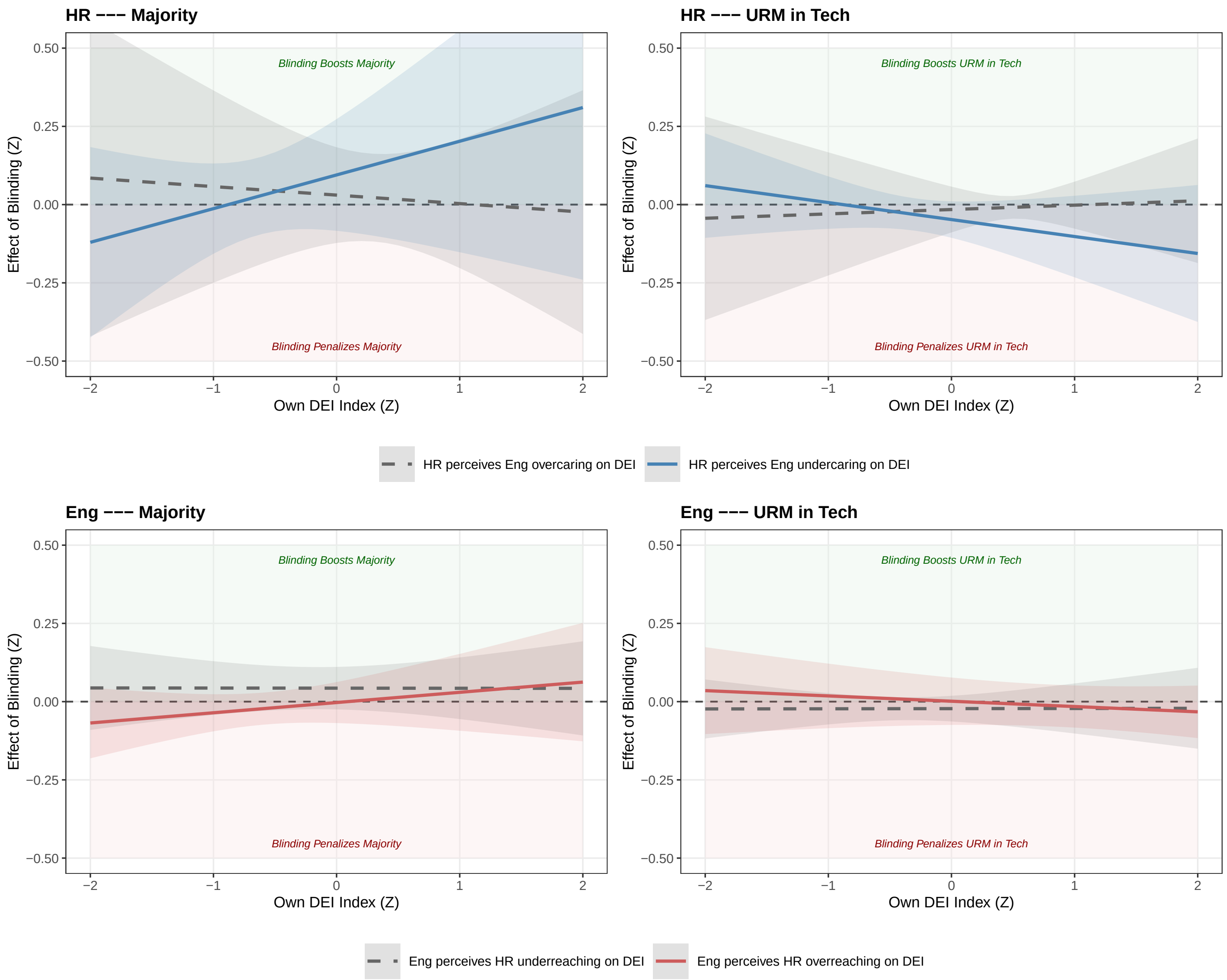
Top row: HR (high Dir = compensation conditions). Bottom row: Eng (high Dir = rebellion conditions). Bands = 95% CI.

3.3 By Dichotomy (Majority vs Minority)

	Simple Dir Het.		Triple: Dir x Own DEI	
	HR	Engineer	HR	Engineer
Majority	0.034 (0.040)	0.028 (0.018)	0.063 (0.055)	0.020 (0.023)
URM in Tech	−0.017 (0.024)	−0.014 (0.017)	−0.032 (0.028)	−0.011 (0.025)
Majority × Dir Idx (Z)	−0.011 (0.054)	−0.013 (0.032)	0.032 (0.065)	−0.023 (0.025)
URM in Tech × Dir Idx (Z)	0.006 (0.010)	0.007 (0.017)	−0.016 (0.019)	0.012 (0.018)
Majority × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.040 (0.084)	0.016 (0.032)
URM in Tech × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.020 (0.050)	−0.008 (0.020)
Majority × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			0.067 (0.065)	0.017 (0.011)
URM in Tech × Dir Idx (Z) × Own DEI Index (Z)			−0.034 (0.028)	−0.009 (0.015)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	×	×	×	×
Respondent Characteristics	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	2034	2124	2034	2124
R^2	0.432	0.737	0.433	0.737
Adj. R^2	0.415	0.730	0.415	0.729
R^2 Within	0.000	0.001	0.002	0.001
Adj. R^2 Within	−0.003	−0.002	−0.004	−0.004

Dir Idx (Z) = signed directional misalignment index. n = 113 HR, 118 Eng. Coefs flipped post-fit so positive = effect of blinding raises the score. Two-way cluster on responseid and resume index.

Dir Idx (signed) × Own DEI Index — URM-Tech Dichotomy



Top row: HR (high Dir = compensation conditions). Bottom row: Eng (high Dir = rebellion conditions). Bands = 95% CI.

4 Treatment Effect on Productivity of Hired (The Efficiency Myth)

Signal Extraction Remains Flat (S5.1.): Removing demographic information (or noise) does *not* meaningfully improve their ability to identify top ability candidates.

Quality of Hires Does Not Improve (S5.2.): Blind hiring has a *null* effect on the actual coding quality of the hired cohort.

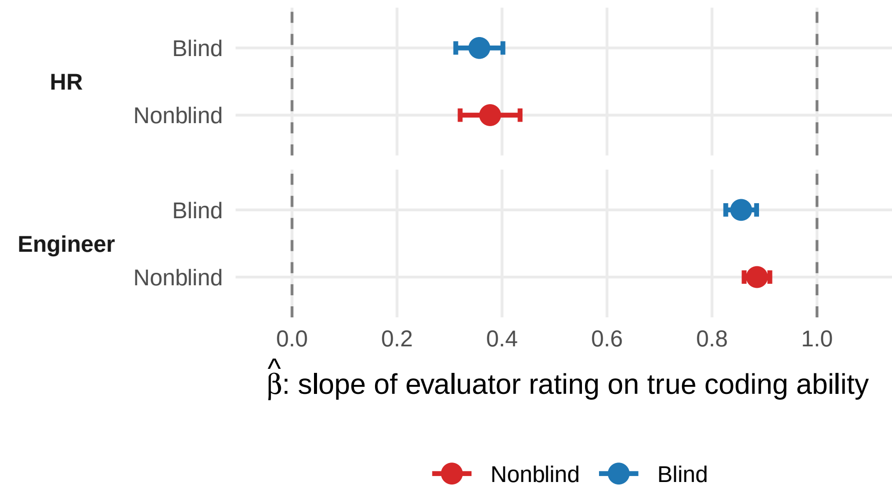
4.1 Does Blinding Lead to More Accurate Coding Skill Evaluations?

Specification:

$$\text{Hiring Evaluation Score (Z)} \sim \text{True Coding Ability (Z)} \times \mathbb{1}[\text{Blind arm}] \mid \text{Respondent FE} + \text{Display Position FE}.$$

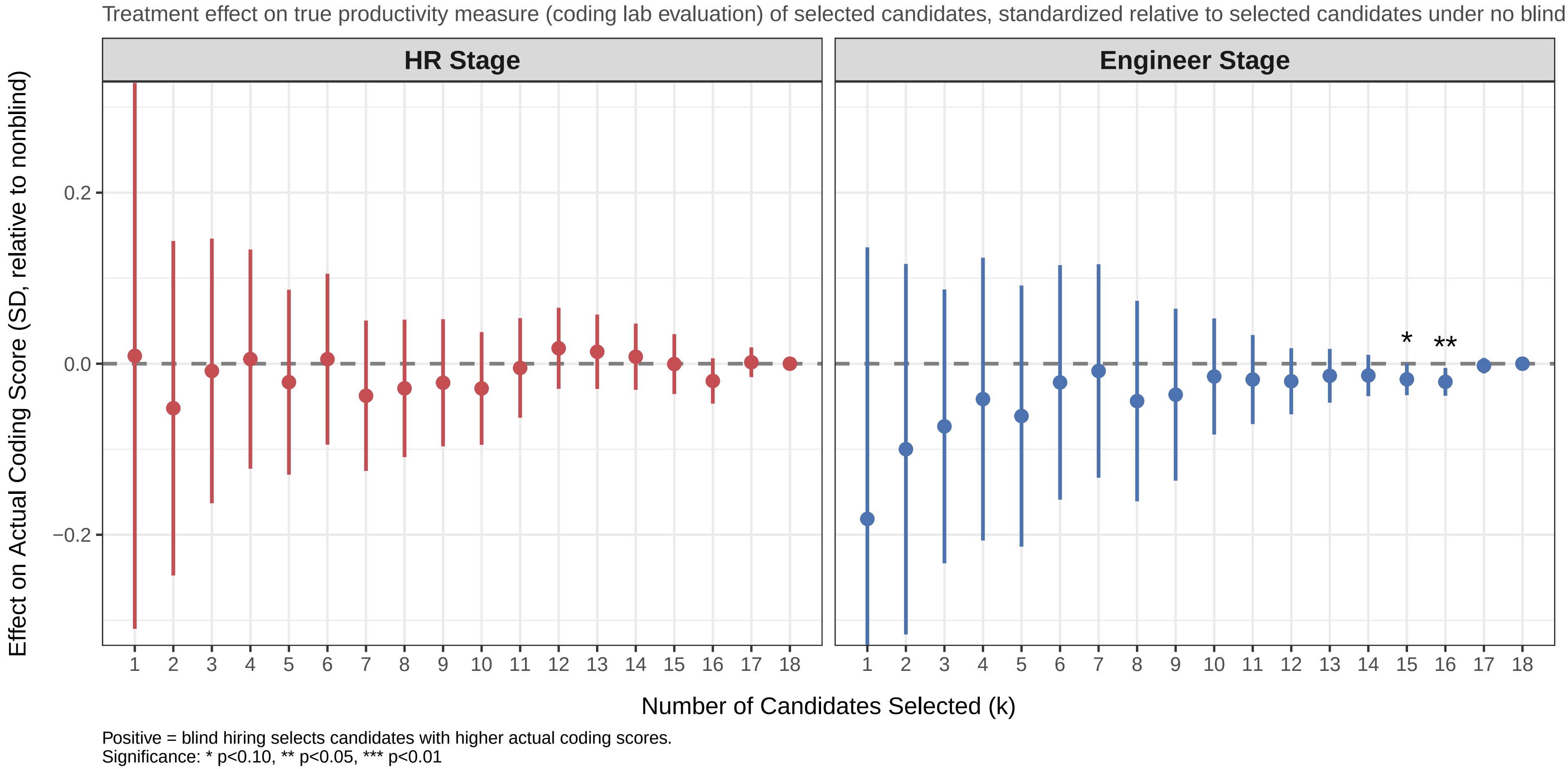
- $H_0 : \beta = 0$ — the evaluator extracts *no signal* from true coding ability.
- $H_0 : \beta = 1$ — the evaluator is *perfectly calibrated*: a 1 SD rise in true ability produces exactly a 1 SD rise in the rating, with no shrinkage.

	HR	Engineer
$\hat{\beta}_{\text{nonblind}}$ (slope, nonblind arm)	0.377 (0.029)	0.886 (0.012)
$\hat{\beta}_{\text{blind}}$ (slope, blind arm)	0.357 (0.023)	0.856 (0.015)
Observations	2,466	2,772
R^2	0.142	0.759
Adj. R^2	0.085	0.743
Resume (Content) FE	×	×
Display Position FE	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓
Respondent Characteristics	×	×



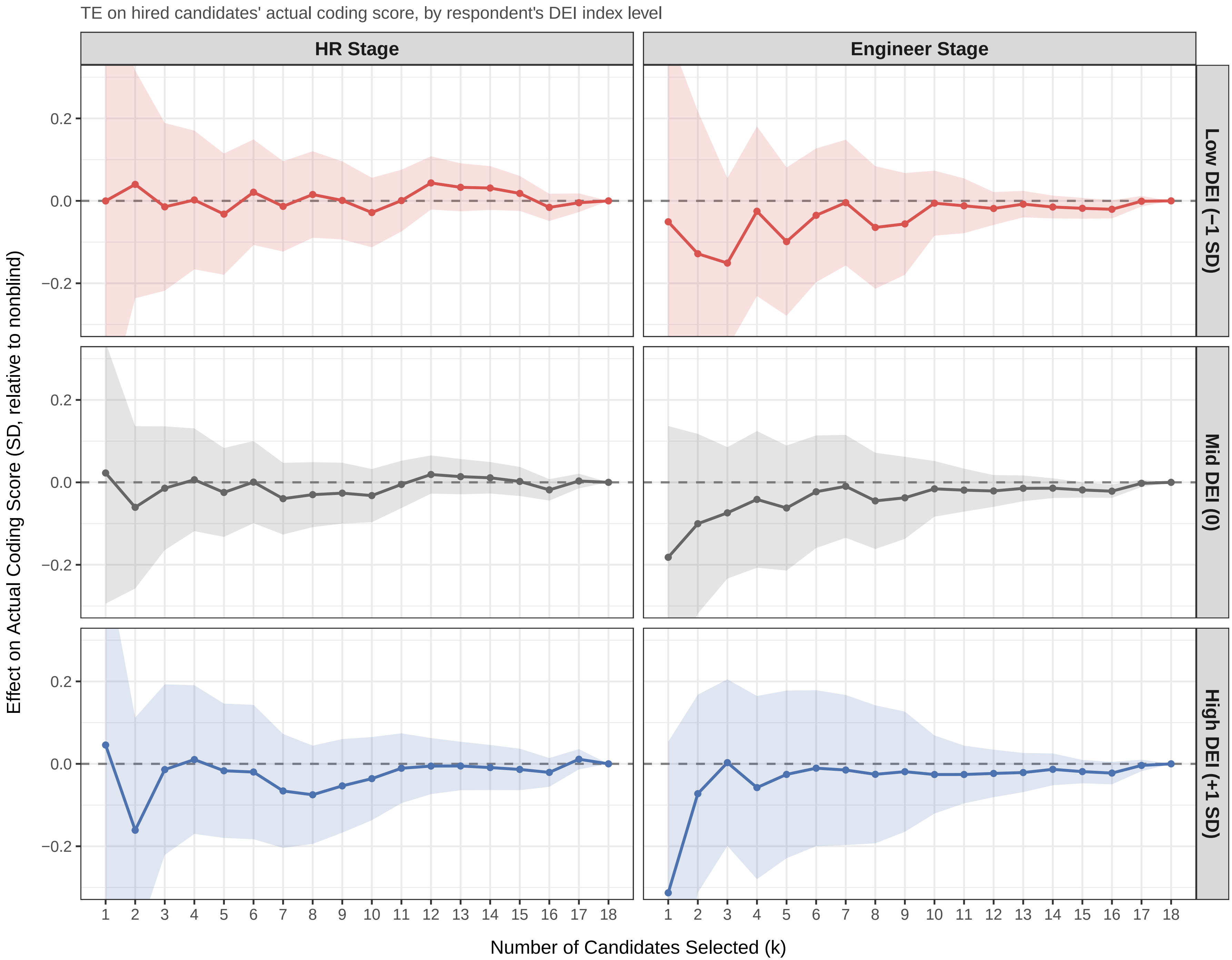
Cluster-robust standard errors (by respondent) shown in parentheses next to each $\hat{\beta}$.
Stars on p-values: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

4.2 Does Blinding Lead to Selection of More Productive Coders?



4.3 Does Blinding's Productivity Effect Differ by Evaluator's DEI Orientation?

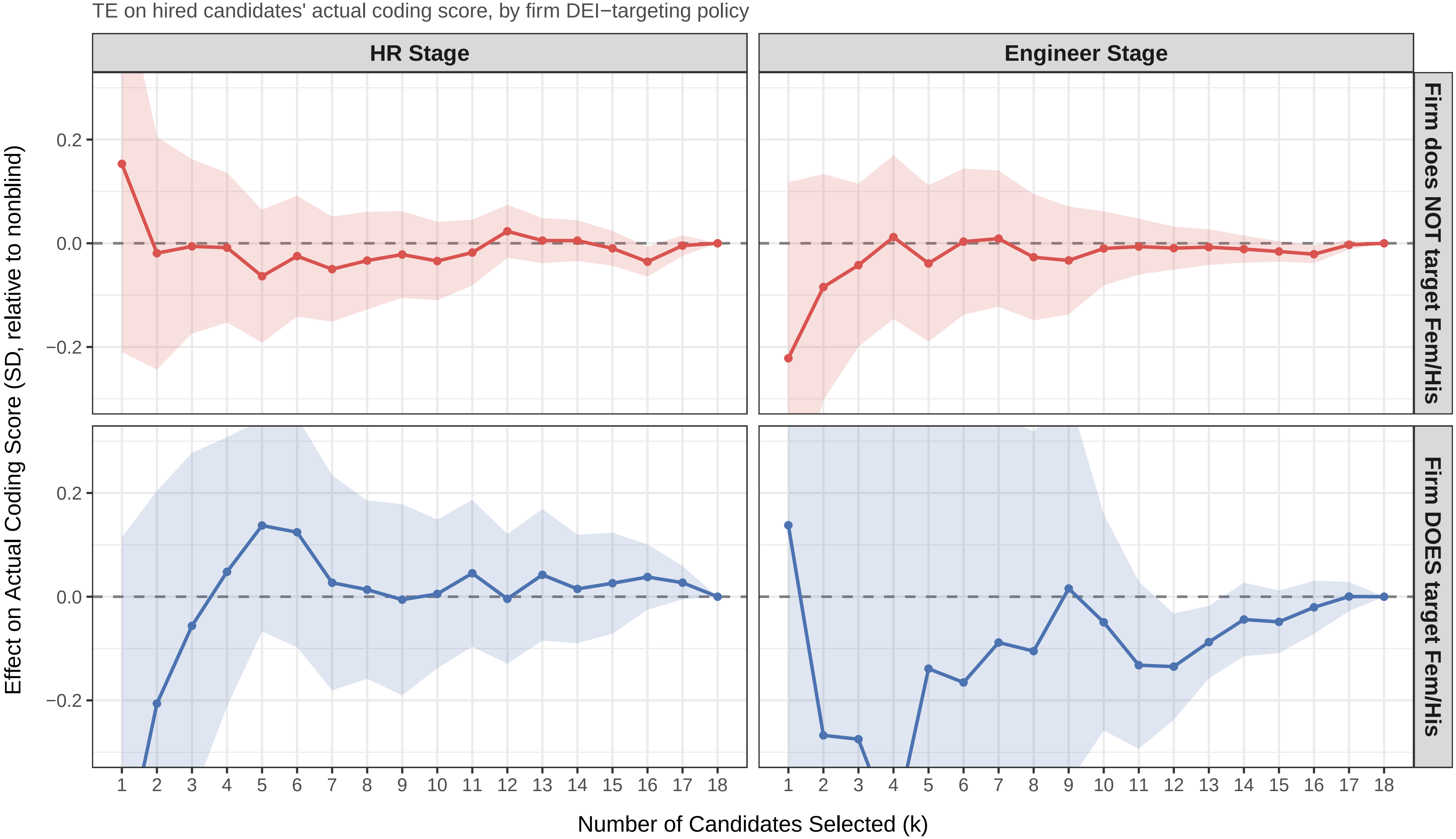
Same per-k loop as §4.2, but the regression interacts `treat` with the respondent's z-scored DEI index (`dei_index_z`, the canonical Individual DEI Index from §2). The treatment effect at each k is then evaluated at low (-1 SD), mid (0), and high (+1 SD) of the DEI index distribution via the linear combination $\hat{\beta}_{\text{blind}} + q\hat{\beta}_{\text{blind}\times\text{DEI}}$, with 95% CIs from $\sqrt{v'\Sigma v}$ where $v = (1, q)$. The substantive question: do pro-DEI respondents pick more productive candidates under blinding than anti-DEI respondents do?



Rows: TE evaluated at −1, 0, +1 SD of the within−role z−scored DEI index. Columns: HR vs Engineer. Bands: 95% CI from the linear combination of treat::blind and treat::blind:dei_index_z.

4.4 Does Blinding's Productivity Effect Differ by Firm DEI-Targeting Policy?

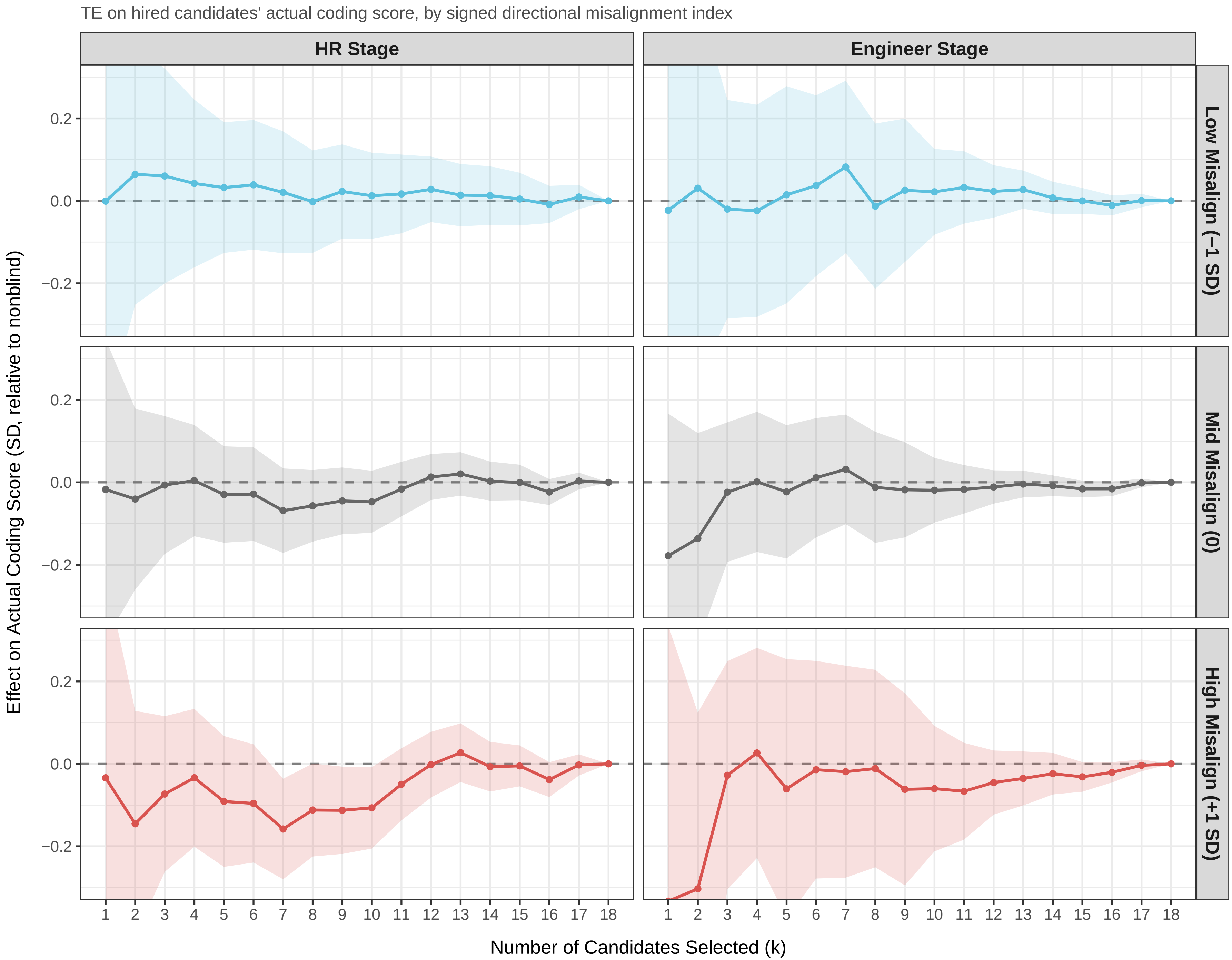
Same per-k design as §4.3, but the moderator is now `firm_targets_fh` — a binary indicator for whether the respondent's firm formally targets Female or Hispanic candidates in hiring (constructed from `s5_policy_diversity`). Two-row × two-column grid: rows are `firm does NOT target'' vs`firm DOES target,'' columns are HR vs Engineer. The substantive question: does formal firm policy crowd out blinding's effect on the productivity of the selected pool?



Rows: firm DOES vs does NOT formally target Female or Hispanic candidates. Columns: HR vs Engineer. Bands: 95% CI.

4.5 Does Blinding's Productivity Effect Differ by Inter-Departmental DEI Misalignment?

Same per-k design, but the moderator is now `misalign_z`, the signed directional misalignment index from §3 (Eng: HR-overreach direction = rebellion conditions; HR: Eng-undercare direction = compensation conditions). Three-row $\times$ two-column grid: rows evaluate at low (-1 SD), mid (0), and high ($+1$ SD) of the index. The substantive question: does perceived inter-departmental DEI misalignment moderate the productivity-of-hired effect?



Rows: TE evaluated at −1, 0, +1 SD of the within−role z−scored signed directional misalignment index from §3. Columns: HR vs Engineer. Bands: 95% CI.